

4. Risks, Assumptions & Dependencies – Plan Conversion QA Program

1. Purpose

This page defines the **key risks**, **critical assumptions**, and **hard dependencies** that will directly impact QA execution, automation feasibility, timelines, and release readiness.

These are the constraints leadership must accept to avoid scope creep and unrealistic expectations.

2. High-Level Summary

Category	Count
Risks	14
Assumptions	12
Dependencies	10

3. Detailed Risks

These risks come from real execution experience on Prime v2/v3, Unite, CSR, Member, Kofax, and backoffice.

Each risk includes impact + mitigation.

3.1 SSO & IDP Risks

Risk 1 – SSO Handshake Failure (WhiteCap Ascensus SSO)

Impact: Automation cannot begin; Member portal blocked
Mitigation: Manual team validates daily; require stable URL + handshake tokens early

Risk 2 – MFA & IDP Flow Cannot Be Automated

Impact: Manual regression required for login flows
Mitigation: Limit login checks to smoke only, IDP login can be tested using V3 automation by disabling MFA

3.2 Metadata & Traunch Risks

Risk 3 – Metadata Delivery Delays

Impact: Blocks CSR automation, API tests, DB validations
Mitigation: Require "Metadata Freeze" milestone before major automation work

Risk 4 – Traunch Mapping Incorrect or Changing

Impact: Breaks API and CSR scripts
Mitigation: Build dynamic tranche/fund map utility

3.3 File & Backoffice Risks

Risk 5 – File Feed Scheduling Instability

Impact: Price/Performance/Recon tests fail intermittently
Mitigation: Mock file injections during early testing

Risk 6 – ACH/Flywire/Mellon Changes Late in Cycle

Impact: Delays Phase 2 validation
Mitigation: Require feed format freeze

3.4 Kofax Risks

Risk 7 – Kofax Schema Changes Not Final

Impact: 20–25% of tests break
Mitigation: Require final XSD before Phase 2

Risk 8 – Kofax Timing Delays

Impact: End-to-end ingest verification takes 24–48 hours
Mitigation: Enable manual feed triggers with DevOps

3.5 Member Portal Risks

Risk 9 – WhiteCap Redirect URL or Token Expiry

Impact: Member hands-off automated smoke blocked
Mitigation: Provide long-lived session accounts or bypass token

Risk 10 – Content or UI Differences Across Plans

Impact: Break automation that assumes generic UI
Mitigation: Parameterize content checks per plan

3.6 Environment & Data Risks

Risk 11 – Stage1 & QC4 Data Drift

Impact: Automation passes in one env and fails in another
Mitigation: Require weekly DB sync or snapshot policy

Risk 12 – Test Data Gets Invalidated by CRON Jobs

Impact: Transactions disappear or become stale
Mitigation: Implement stable test data creator + daily validation

3.7 Execution & Staffing Risks

Risk 13 – Too Few Automation Resources

Impact: Timeline becomes unrealistic; lower coverage
Mitigation: Minimum 2 SDETs required

Risk 14 – Parallel Release Cycles (CSR/Member/Backend)

Impact: Constant rework on automation scripts
Mitigation: Introduce gating "QA Release Freeze Window"

4. Assumptions (Critical for Planning)

These must hold true; otherwise timeline will slip.

4.1 Metadata & Backend Assumptions

1. PlanID, funds, tranches delivered at least **2 weeks before UAT**
2. Age-based roll rules final

3. Contribution/withdrawal limits finalized
 4. Metadata changes after freeze will be limited to additions, not rewrites
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4.2 API & UI Assumptions

1. All required APIs for Account/Allocation/Metadata are available in Stage1
 2. No breaking API changes after Week 2
 3. CSR UI shell remains unchanged (header/footer/layout)
 4. Member UI post-SSO flow remains stable
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4.3 Backoffice & File Assumptions

1. All daemons (ACH, Price, Recon, Performance, Max Contrib) run daily
 2. File drop locations consistent across environments
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4.4 Kofax Assumptions

1. Kofax Dev/Stage environments stable
2. All feed formats provided upfront

5. Dependencies (Must Be Provided by Dev/Backend/WhiteCap)

5.1 WhiteCap Dependencies

1. SSO handshake integration (URL, keys, redirect paths)
 2. Test accounts for Member portal with working SSO tokens
 3. Web registration flag configurations
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5.2 Backend Data Dependencies

1. Complete metadata: PlanID, funds, tranches, portfolios
 2. Age-based roll rules
 3. Contribution/withdrawal settings
 4. UGIFT flags
 5. File feed wiring
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5.3 Kofax Dependencies

1. XSD/schema for all feeds
2. Vouchers/templates for Kofax mapping

6. Non-Negotiables (Leadership Must Acknowledge)

Here are the **harsh realities** that must be accepted up front:

1. SSO is trial & error technique, hope that works well.
2. IDP login - will work with MFA disabled flows.
3. Metadata freeze is mandatory. Without it project slips.
4. CSR automation requires new test users cannot reuse old ones.
5. File feeds (Price/Recon/Performance) depend on DevOps schedules.
6. Kofax end-to-end ingestion - need to validate on this like how much time it will take etc.
7. Conversion suite cannot be built until Phase 1 completely passes.
8. 2 automation engineers are required. Not optional.

Without these constraints accepted, no realistic delivery date can be committed.

7. Risk Response Plan

Risk Type	Response
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Technical	API smoke daily, file feed mocks, early SSO validation
Resource	Enforce 2x automation hiring (depends on priority & timeline)
Timeline	Gate releases until metadata freeze
Environment	Daily smoke + proactive monitoring
File Jobs	Use DevOps triggers for testing
Kofax	Perform feed simulation early

8. Escalation Path

- Metadata delays Backend & PM
- SSO token failures WhiteCap integration team
- Test User with MFA disabled WhiteCap integration team (need at least 5 users)
- File feed issues DevOps
- Kofax schema QA team
- CSR/Member UI issues UI/UX + Development
- Automation blockers Swapnil & Pramod (technical)
- Scope creep Henry (leadership decision)

9. Review & Sign-Off

This section is a placeholder for leadership sign-off after review:

- **QA Automation Lead (Pramod + Swapnil) – Approved / Pending**
- **QA Architect (Pramod + Swapnil) – Approved / Pending**
- **Backend Lead – Approved / Pending**
- **WhiteCap Integration Lead – Approved / Pending**
- **Product Owner – Approved / Pending**
- **Engineering Manager (Henry + Hose) – Approved / Pending**